considered a strategic asset used towards furthering gains in foreign policy and investment and sustaining Indian cultures.

An annual event called the Pravasi Bharatiya Divas was launched in 2003 to connect with overseas Indians. It is held on 9 January every year to commemorate the date of Gandhi's return from South Africa to India in 1915. During its first celebration, the then Prime Minister, Atal Behari Vajpayee, pleaded for ideas more than investment and the richness of experiences more than riches.[64] In practice though, the focus has been on investment and riches, and a proactive concern about the welfare of overseas Indians. In 2004, the ministry of overseas Indian affairs was created though this was later submerged within the ministry of external affairs in 2016. And while dual citizenship is still not permitted, a new category called the Overseas Indian Citizen was created with the major benefit of not requiring an Indian visa to travel to India even after giving up Indian citizenship. Dual identities however remained, and the world 'transnational' came into vogue to reflect the many connections that migrants continued to have with their homeland, facilitated by easier transport, communication and satellite television. For the Indian diasporas, dreams were first about aspiration and return and only much later about assimilation. Diaspora conflicts were first with the natives and only then inter-generational. This was equally true of immigrant diasporas based in India—Sri Lankan, Tibetan, Afghan and others—even though most of them emerged from involuntary migration, the subject of the next chapter.